

TPAC Senior Leadership Development Programme

Senior leadership, strategic decision-making, people leadership and public-sector governance

Level: Advanced / Senior Leadership **Duration:** 6 hours

Complete Training Manual

Proposed Table of Contents

1. Course Overview
2. Learning Objectives
3. Course Structure
4. Leadership Foundations and Public-Sector Context
5. Strategic Thinking and Decision-Making
6. Leading People, Teams and Change
7. Stakeholder Leadership and Collaborative Governance
8. Communication, Presence and Crisis Leadership
9. Results, Accountability and Continuous Improvement
10. Integrated Public-Sector Case Study
11. Assessment Bank
12. Final Assignment and Rubric
13. Glossary
14. Quick Reference
15. References and Verification Notes

1. Course Overview

Designed for senior government officials who lead people, decisions and institutional outcomes under public accountability.

2. Learning Objectives

- Frame challenges around public outcomes and mandate.
- Make defensible decisions under uncertainty.
- Lead teams through change and conflict.
- Coordinate stakeholders across organisational boundaries.
- Communicate clearly in routine and crisis settings.
- Create review mechanisms that produce learning.

3. Course Structure

Module	Focus	Time
1. Leadership Foundations and Public-Sector Context	Understand senior leadership as stewardship: direction, alignment, accountable decisions and institutional trust.	60 min
2. Strategic Thinking and Decision-Making	Convert complex information into timely, defensible decisions.	60 min
3. Leading People, Teams and Change	Lead multidisciplinary teams, manage resistance and sustain change.	60 min
4. Stakeholder Leadership and Collaborative Governance	Lead across departments, levels of government and partners.	60 min
5. Communication, Presence and Crisis Leadership	Lead clearly under pressure when information is incomplete.	60 min
6. Results, Accountability and Continuous Improvement	Translate leadership intent into measurable outcomes and learning.	60 min

4. Leadership Foundations and Public-Sector Context

Purpose: Understand senior leadership as stewardship: direction, alignment, accountable decisions and institutional trust.

Core topics

- Leadership vs management
- Strategic alignment with mandates and public value
- Decision rights, delegation and accountability
- Leading through ambiguity and scrutiny
- Ethical leadership and role modelling

Practical activities

- Map mandate, outcomes and decision rights
- Analyse a leadership dilemma
- Create a leadership charter

Expected outputs

- Leadership charter
- Decision-rights map
- Personal development priorities

5. Strategic Thinking and Decision-Making

Purpose: Convert complex information into timely, defensible decisions.

Core topics

- Problem definition and root causes
- Evidence, assumptions and uncertainty
- Options appraisal and trade-offs
- Scenario planning
- Decision logs and review

Practical activities

- Create a decision statement
- Compare options using weighted criteria
- Build a decision log

Expected outputs

- Decision brief
- Options matrix
- Decision log

6. Leading People, Teams and Change

Purpose: Lead multidisciplinary teams, manage resistance and sustain change.

Core topics

- Team purpose and roles
- Delegation and performance conversations
- Conflict and difficult conversations
- Change readiness
- Coaching and feedback

Practical activities

- Diagnose a team problem
- Role-play a difficult conversation
- Create a change stakeholder map

Expected outputs

- Team operating agreement
- Conversation plan
- Change map

7. Stakeholder Leadership and Collaborative Governance

Purpose: Lead across departments, levels of government and partners.

Core topics

- Stakeholder power and interest
- Interdepartmental coordination
- Consultation vs decision authority
- Managing disagreement
- Escalation protocols

Practical activities

- Build influence/interest matrix
- Prepare a negotiation
- Design a governance agenda

Expected outputs

- Stakeholder strategy
- Negotiation plan
- Governance agenda

8. Communication, Presence and Crisis Leadership

Purpose: Lead clearly under pressure when information is incomplete.

Core topics

- Executive presence
- Briefing senior leaders
- Crisis roles and rapid updates
- Public-facing communication
- Rumour correction

Practical activities

- Deliver a two-minute brief
- Write a holding statement
- Run a crisis update simulation

Expected outputs

- Executive brief
- Crisis message
- Update cadence

9. Results, Accountability and Continuous Improvement

Purpose: Translate leadership intent into measurable outcomes and learning.

Core topics

- Outcome-oriented performance
- Leading vs lagging indicators
- Review cadences
- Learning from failure
- 90-day action planning

Practical activities

- Design a leadership scorecard
- Run a performance review
- Create a 90-day plan

Expected outputs

- Scorecard
- Review agenda
- 90-day plan

10. Integrated Public-Sector Case Study

A state-level programme is behind schedule, departments disagree on ownership, field teams report inconsistent guidance, and senior leadership wants a recovery plan within 72 hours. Data are incomplete and public scrutiny is increasing.

Tasks

- Define the leadership problem separately from operational symptoms.
- Identify decisions required within 72 hours and their owners.
- Design a stakeholder and communication plan.
- Specify minimum indicators for recovery.

Debrief

- Which decisions require senior authority?
- How should uncertainty be communicated?
- Which leadership behaviours would restore or damage trust?

11. Assessment Bank

Multiple-choice questions

1. Which best describes strategic leadership in government?

A. Maximising internal activity B. Aligning people and resources to public outcomes C. Avoiding all risk D. Delegating every decision

2. A decision log is most useful for:

A. Replacing accountability B. Recording assumptions, decisions and rationale C. Eliminating uncertainty D. Tracking attendance

3. When stakeholders disagree, a strong first step is to:

A. Ignore disagreement B. Clarify interests, evidence and decision rights C. Escalate everything D. Choose the loudest stakeholder

4. A leading indicator is:

A. A future-performance signal B. Only a financial measure C. A historical narrative D. A final audit finding

5. During a crisis, leaders should:

A. Fill gaps with guesses B. Share verified facts, uncertainty and next update time C. Wait for every fact D. Avoid documenting decisions

6. Effective delegation requires:

A. Transfer of accountability B. Clear authority, outcomes, boundaries and review C. No decision rights D. Only verbal instructions

7. Psychological safety helps teams:

A. Avoid all disagreement B. Raise concerns and learn without fear of humiliation C. Remove standards D. Eliminate hierarchy

8. Options appraisal should make trade-offs:

A. Invisible B. Explicit and comparable C. Purely political D. Irrelevant

9. A leadership scorecard should focus on:

A. Activities only B. Meaningful outcome and execution signals C. Maximum indicators D. Popularity

10. Continuous improvement is strongest when reviews:

A. Assign blame B. Convert evidence into corrective action and learning C. Only happen after failure D. Avoid changing plans

True / False

1. Authority and accountability are always identical.
2. Leaders should distinguish facts from assumptions.
3. Stakeholder engagement gives every stakeholder veto power.
4. Clear escalation routes can reduce delays.
5. Feedback is most useful when specific and observable.

Short-answer

1. Explain leadership vs management in government.
2. What belongs in an executive decision brief?
3. How should uncertainty be communicated?
4. Why are leading indicators useful?
5. List four elements of effective delegation.

Scenario questions

1. A district team says a central directive is unrealistic while headquarters says local teams are non-compliant. How would you lead resolution?

2. A sensitive incident is attracting public attention but facts are incomplete. What would you do in the first two hours?

Answer key

1. 1-B: aligns resources and decisions to public outcomes.
2. 2-B: preserves rationale and assumptions.
3. 3-B: creates a basis for resolution.
4. 4-A: provides an early signal.
5. 5-B: uses verified facts and predictable updates.
6. 6-B: requires authority, boundaries and review.
7. 7-B: supports raising concerns while retaining standards.
8. 8-B: makes trade-offs visible.
9. 9-B: keeps indicators selective and outcome-oriented.
10. 10-B: turns evidence into action.
11. 11-False.
12. 12-True.
13. 13-False.
14. 14-True.
15. 15-True.

12. Final Assignment and Rubric

Prepare a 10–12 page leadership improvement plan for a government programme or administrative unit.

Components

- Mandate and outcomes
- Leadership challenges and evidence
- Decision-rights and stakeholder map
- Team/change strategy
- Executive communication and crisis readiness
- Performance scorecard
- 90-day personal leadership plan

Criterion	Weight
Problem framing / objectives	20%
Method and execution plan	25%
Stakeholder / communication quality	20%
Risk, monitoring and governance	20%
Clarity and professionalism	15%

13. Glossary

Stewardship: Responsible use of public authority and resources.

Decision rights: Explicit allocation of who recommends, decides, executes, reviews and escalates.

Leading indicator: An early signal that anticipates future performance.

Psychological safety: A climate where people can raise concerns and mistakes without humiliation or retaliation.

Stakeholder: A person or organisation affecting, affected by, or legitimately interested in an initiative.

Escalation: Moving an issue to higher authority when it exceeds agreed boundaries or risk thresholds.

Public value: Benefits produced through legitimate, effective and responsible public action.

14. Quick Reference

- Mandate → outcome → decision rights → stakeholders → evidence → options → decision → execution → review.
- Use concise executive messages: situation, implication, ask, owner, next step.
- Separate facts, assumptions, risks and unresolved questions.
- Delegate with clear authority and boundaries.
- Make trade-offs explicit.
- Use predictable review cadences.
- In crisis: verified facts → unknowns → actions → owner → next update.

15. References and Verification Notes

OECD, *Government at a Glance 2025*, OECD Publishing, 2025.

https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/government-at-a-glance-2025_0efd0f37-en.html

OECD, *Recommendation of the Council on Public Service Leadership and Capability*, 2019.

<https://legalinstruments.oecd.org/en/instruments/OECD-LEGAL-0445>

UNDP, public-sector governance and leadership resources. <https://www.undp.org/>

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